languages for higher education and Rs 45,000 crore for performance-based incentives for carrying out agricultural reforms of amending land-leasing laws, maintaining and augmenting groundwater stock, growth in agriculture exports and encouraging production of oilseeds, pulses and wood and wood-based products. The sector-specific grants also included grants for health (Rs 31,755 crore), maintenance of Pradhan Mantri Gram Sadak Yojana (PMGSY) for roads (Rs 27,539 crore), judiciary (Rs 10,425 crore), statistics (Rs 1175 crore) and aspirational districts and blocks (Rs 3150 crore).

Finally, bringing back the old concept of state-specific grants with a total of Rs 49,599 grants for states. All states have been recommended to receive these grants with Karnataka getting the largest share of Rs 6000 crore. The total grants package was estimated at Rs 10,33,062 crore by the Commission.

The Explanatory Memorandum laid before the Parliament informed that the government, for the grants recommended by the Fifteenth Finance Commission, had accepted the recommendation of the post-devolution deficit grants amounting to Rs 2,94,514 crore, including the amounts recommended for each of the states and the manner of providing the grants as contained in the report of the Commission. It also accepted the recommendations with respect to local bodies' grants and disaster-related grants as recommended by the Commission.

The government, however, did not accept the recommendations of the Commission for the grants to states for specific sectors and stated, 'The government will give due consideration to sectors identified by the Commission while formulating and implementing existing and new Centrally Sponsored and Central Sector Schemes.' It also did not accept the recommendations of the Commission for state-specific grants as well and instead stated, 'Keeping in view the untied resources with the state